

# Bobcat

Webelos Required Adventure: Character & Leadership



**Rank:** Webelos (4th grade) | **Type:** Required adventure | **Time:** 2 den meetings + 1 at-home activity

**Den leader:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Dates:** \_\_\_\_\_

## What's in this guide

1. Adventure at a glance
2. Meeting plans
3. Requirement-by-requirement teaching notes
4. Den tracking sheet & denner rotation
5. Printables: Human Bingo, Scout Law cards

Companion files in this folder: **Scout-Handout.pdf** (one double-sided sheet per scout) and **Parent-Letter.pdf** (send home for requirement 7).

## The big idea

Bobcat is the first adventure every Webelos earns, and it sets the tone for the whole year. It's about **who we are as a den**: we get to know each other, we learn the promises Scouts make (the Scout Oath and Scout Law), we decide together how we'll treat each other (our Code of Conduct), and we start sharing leadership (the denner). Most 4th graders have heard the Oath and Law before. This year, the goal is for them to understand what the words *mean* and to start living them.

### Goals for your scouts

- **Belong:** Every scout knows everyone's name and something about them, and feels like part of the den.
- **Promise:** Recite the Scout Oath and Law, and explain the three duties in the Oath in their own words.
- **Understand:** Explain what each point of the Scout Law looks like in real life.
- **Lead:** Know what a denner does and get excited to take a turn.
- **Own it:** Help write the den's Code of Conduct and agree to follow it.
- **Show it:** Use the Cub Scout sign, salute, and handshake correctly and know when to use each.

### The requirements

| # | Requirement (summary)                                                                                                                                  | When we do it |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| 1 | Get to know members of your den.                                                                                                                       | Meeting 1     |
| 2 | Recite the Scout Oath and the Scout Law with your den and den leader. Describe 3 points of the Scout Oath.                                             | Meeting 1     |
| 3 | Learn about the Scout Law.                                                                                                                             | Meeting 2     |
| 4 | Learn about the denner position and responsibilities.                                                                                                  | Meeting 2     |
| 5 | With your den, create a den Code of Conduct.                                                                                                           | Meeting 2     |
| 6 | Demonstrate the Cub Scout sign, Cub Scout salute, and Cub Scout handshake. Show how each is used.                                                      | Meeting 1     |
| 7 | At home, with your parent or legal guardian, do the activities in the booklet <i>How to Protect Your Children from Child Abuse: A Parent's Guide</i> . | At home       |

Always confirm requirement wording against the current Webelos Handbook or Scouting America's online adventure page; requirements are summarized here for planning.

### Supplies checklist

- |                                                                                           |                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Scout Handout (1 per scout) and Parent Letter (1 per family)     | <input type="checkbox"/> Poster board and markers (Code of Conduct)                                            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Human Bingo sheets (printable at the back of this guide)         | <input type="checkbox"/> Three buckets or boxes labeled <i>God &amp; Country</i> , <i>Others</i> , <i>Self</i> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Scout Law cards, cut apart (printable at the back of this guide) | <input type="checkbox"/> Denner shoulder cord (if your pack uses one)                                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Scout Oath written on a poster or whiteboard                     | <input type="checkbox"/> Pencils, den tracking sheet                                                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Soft ball or beanbag                                             | <input type="checkbox"/> American flag for the opening                                                         |

## Meeting 1: "Who We Are" (about 60 min)

Covers requirements 1, 2, and 6.

| Time   | Segment            | What happens                                                                                                                            |
|--------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10 min | Gathering (Req. 1) | <b>Human Bingo:</b> scouts mingle and get classmates to sign squares. Adults play too!                                                  |
| 5 min  | Opening            | Flag ceremony. Leader leads the Scout Oath and Law. Welcome: "This year you're Webelos. That stands for <b>WE'LL BE LOyal Scouts.</b> " |
| 10 min | Req. 1             | <b>Name Toss</b> and <b>Two Truths and a Tall Tale.</b>                                                                                 |
| 10 min | Req. 6             | Teach the sign, salute, and handshake. Play <b>Leader Says</b> . Introduce the sign as the den's quiet signal.                          |
| 20 min | Req. 2             | Talk through the Scout Oath, then play <b>Oath Scramble</b> and <b>Three Duties Sort</b> . Close by reciting the Oath and Law together. |
| 5 min  | Closing            | Cubmaster's Minute (Req. 7 page). Send home the Scout Handout and Parent Letter.                                                        |

## Meeting 2: "How We Lead" (about 60 min)

Covers requirements 3, 4, and 5.

| Time   | Segment   | What happens                                                                                                              |
|--------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 min  | Gathering | <b>Scout Law Relay:</b> teams race to put the 12 Scout Law cards in order.                                                |
| 5 min  | Opening   | Flag ceremony, Scout Oath and Law. Quick check: show the Cub Scout sign, salute, and handshake.                           |
| 20 min | Req. 3    | Walk through the 12 points using the kid-friendly meanings. Play <b>Which Point Is It?</b> and <b>Scout Law Charades.</b> |
| 10 min | Req. 4    | Explain the denner role. Choose the first denner and set the rotation so everyone gets a turn.                            |
| 15 min | Req. 5    | Write the den <b>Code of Conduct</b> together on poster board; everyone signs it.                                         |
| 5 min  | Closing   | New denner leads the closing. Remind families about Requirement 7.                                                        |

### Requirement 7 happens at home

Leaders do not teach Requirement 7 in the den meeting. Send home the **Parent Letter**, which explains the booklet and has a tear-off slip for families to return when they're done. Mark it complete when the parent or guardian tells you it's finished.

### Tip: make it stick all year

Open every meeting with the Oath and Law, bring the Code of Conduct poster to every meeting, and rotate the denner on a regular schedule. When you catch a scout living a point of the Scout Law, name it out loud: "That was *helpful!*"

## 1

## REQUIREMENT 1

Get to know members of your den.

**Goal:** Every scout learns everyone's name and at least one fun fact about each den member. A den where scouts feel known is a den where they behave better and want to come back.

**SAY IT LIKE THIS**

"A den is like a team. Good teams know each other, including what everybody is good at, what they like, and what makes them laugh. This year we're going to camp together, build things together, and maybe get a little muddy together. So first, let's find out who's on our team!"

**ACTIVITY**

**Human Bingo (10 min, gathering).** Print the bingo sheet at the back of this guide. Scouts find someone who matches each square and have them sign it. Each person can sign only one square per sheet. First row across, down, or diagonal wins, but keep playing until most squares are full. Afterward, ask: "Who found someone surprising?"

**Name Toss (5 min).** Stand in a circle. Say your name and your favorite food, then toss the ball to someone else. Round 2: say the *catcher's* name and their favorite food before you toss. Round 3: go faster!

**Two Truths and a Tall Tale (5 min).** Each scout shares three "facts" about themselves, two true and one made up. The den guesses which is the tall tale. Leaders go first to model it.

**CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING**

- Can each scout name every member of the den? Go around the circle to check.
- Ask: "What's something you have in common with someone you didn't know before?"

**New scouts in the den?**

Pair each new scout with a returning scout as their "den buddy" for the first month. The buddy helps them learn the Oath, Law, and sign, and makes sure they're never standing alone.

## 2

## REQUIREMENT 2

Recite the Scout Oath and the Scout Law with your den and den leader. Describe 3 points of the Scout Oath.

**Goal:** Scouts can say the Oath and Law with the den and explain, in their own words, the three duties the Oath promises: **duty to God and country**, **duty to others**, and **duty to self**.

### The Scout Oath

On my honor I will do my best  
to do my duty to God and my country and to obey the Scout Law;  
to help other people at all times;  
to keep myself physically strong, mentally awake, and morally straight.

### SAY IT LIKE THIS

"An oath is a big promise. When you say '**On my honor,**' you're saying, 'You can count on me.' And '**I will do my best**' is our Cub Scout motto: nobody's perfect, but we always try. The Oath has three big promises in it, which we call **duties**:"

- **Duty to God and country:** Practice your family's faith and respect other people's beliefs. Be a good citizen: respect the flag, follow the laws, and help your community.
- **Duty to others:** Help people all the time, not just when someone's watching or when you feel like it.
- **Duty to self:** Take care of yourself. *Physically strong* means eat healthy, exercise, and sleep. *Mentally awake* means keep learning and stay curious. *Morally straight* means do the right thing and be honest, even when it's hard.

### ACTIVITY

**Oath Scramble (8 min).** Write each line of the Oath on a paper strip (6 strips per set). Teams race to put their strips in order, then read it aloud together. Round 2: flip a strip face down and recite the missing line from memory.

**Three Duties Sort (8 min).** Label three buckets *God & Country*, *Others*, *Self*. Read each action aloud; scouts toss a beanbag into the bucket where it fits (some fit more than one, so talk about it!):

Stand quietly for the flag (Country)  
Pick up trash at a park (Country/Others)  
Carry groceries for a neighbor (Others)  
Sit with a new kid at lunch (Others)  
Go to bed on time (Self: physically strong)  
Read a book for fun (Self: mentally awake)

Tell the truth when you broke something (Self: morally straight)  
Attend worship with your family (God)  
Learn the Pledge of Allegiance (Country)  
Play outside instead of screens (Self: physically strong)

### CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

- Recite the Oath and Law together as a den. Sign off scouts who participate.
- Ask each scout to describe the three duties in their own words, or name one thing they could do this week for each.

On "duty to God": Scouting is non-sectarian. Let families lead on faith, and never ask scouts to share their personal beliefs in front of the group.

## 3

## REQUIREMENT 3

Learn about the Scout Law.

**Goal:** Scouts understand what each of the 12 points means and can give an example of it from their own lives.

## SAY IT LIKE THIS

"The Scout Oath is our promise. The Scout Law is our *how-to guide*: 12 words that describe the kind of person a Scout is. Notice it doesn't say 'A Scout *tries* to be...' It says '**A Scout is.**' These are things you can be every day, at school, at home, and on the playground."

| A Scout is...      | What it means                                                                 | Looks like...                                     |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Trustworthy</b> | Tells the truth and keeps promises. People can count on you.                  | Returning extra change at the store               |
| <b>Loyal</b>       | Sticks by your family, friends, den, and country.                             | Not joining in when others talk about a friend    |
| <b>Helpful</b>     | Helps others without being asked or paid.                                     | Clearing the table without being told             |
| <b>Friendly</b>    | A friend to all, including people who are different from you.                 | Inviting a kid who's alone to play                |
| <b>Courteous</b>   | Polite to everyone and uses good manners.                                     | Saying please and thank you; holding a door       |
| <b>Kind</b>        | Treats others the way you want to be treated; gentle with people and animals. | Checking on a classmate who fell down             |
| <b>Obedient</b>    | Follows the rules at home, school, and in the pack.                           | Following the Code of Conduct                     |
| <b>Cheerful</b>    | Looks on the bright side and does tough jobs with a smile.                    | Staying positive when it rains on a campout       |
| <b>Thrifty</b>     | Doesn't waste. Takes care of things and saves money.                          | Turning off lights; saving part of your allowance |
| <b>Brave</b>       | Does the right thing even when scared or when others laugh.                   | Standing up for someone being picked on           |
| <b>Clean</b>       | Keeps body, mind, and places clean.                                           | Using kind words; cleaning up the campsite        |
| <b>Reverent</b>    | Respects God and respects other people's beliefs.                             | Being respectful during someone else's prayer     |

## ACTIVITY

**Scout Law Relay (gathering).** Two teams, two sets of Scout Law cards (printable at the back of this guide). Race to lay them out in order.

**Which Point Is It? (10 min).** Hand each scout a few Scout Law cards. Read a situation; scouts hold up the point it shows. "You found a wallet and turned it in" (Trustworthy). "You tried a hard hike even though you were nervous" (Brave). "You shared your snack with someone who forgot theirs" (Kind/Helpful). "You used both sides of the paper" (Thrifty). "You said 'good game' to the other team after losing" (Courteous/Cheerful).

**Scout Law Charades (8 min).** A scout draws a card and acts out that point with no words. The den guesses.

## CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

Ask each scout: "Which point of the Scout Law is easiest for you? Which one do you want to work on?"

## 4

## REQUIREMENT 4

Learn about the denner position and responsibilities.

**Goal:** Scouts know what a denner does, why it matters, and that everyone will get a turn. This is the first step toward the youth-led patrols they'll join in Scouts BSA.

## SAY IT LIKE THIS

"In Webelos, scouts start doing some of the leading. The **denner** is a den member who helps lead the den for a while, and then the job passes to someone else, so everybody gets a turn. When you're denner, the den is counting on you to set a good example."

## What a denner does

- Helps the den leader set up and clean up
- Leads the flag ceremony, Oath, or Law at the opening
- Helps lead games and activities
- Helps the den stay on track using the Code of Conduct
- Represents the den at pack meetings
- Sets a good example by living the Scout Law

## How to set it up

- Rotate on a schedule you pick (for example, monthly), so every scout serves during the year.
- Choose the first denner by den vote or by drawing names.
- Some dens also have an **assistant denner** who becomes the next denner.
- If your pack uses one, the denner wears the denner shoulder cord during their term.
- Record the rotation on the tracking sheet.

## ACTIVITY

**Denner Job Jar (5 min).** Put slips in a jar: "Lead the Scout Oath," "Hand out supplies," "Lead the cleanup," "Explain a game," "Welcome a visitor." Scouts draw one and do it right then. Talk about it: "Which job was easy? Which was hard? What makes a good leader?"

**Choose the first denner (5 min).** Hold the vote or drawing, and present the cord if you have one. Their first job is to lead the closing today.

## CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

- Name two things a denner does.
- Why does the denner job rotate? (So everyone gets to practice leading.)
- Which point of the Scout Law is most important for a denner? (Any good answer, such as Helpful, Trustworthy, or Courteous.)

## 5

## REQUIREMENT 5

With your den, create a den Code of Conduct.

**Goal:** The den writes its own rules for how they'll treat each other, so scouts *own* them. Scouts follow rules they helped write far better than rules handed to them.

**SAY IT LIKE THIS**

"Every good team has rules everybody agrees on. Tonight, **you** get to write ours. Think about what makes a den meeting fun and fair for everyone, and what makes it *not* fun. Our rules should match the Scout Law."

**How to run it (15 min)**

1. **Brainstorm.** Ask: "What makes a great den meeting? What ruins one?" Write every idea on a whiteboard.
2. **Make it positive.** Turn "Don't interrupt" into "*We listen when someone is talking.*" Turn "No hitting" into "*We keep our hands to ourselves.*"
3. **Keep it short.** Combine ideas into 5–8 rules. Scouts should be able to remember them.
4. **Connect it to the Scout Law.** For each rule, ask "Which point of the Scout Law is this?"
5. **Agree on what happens** if someone forgets a rule. For example: 1st, a friendly reminder (the Cub Scout sign); 2nd, a short time-out; 3rd, a talk with parents.
6. **Sign it.** The denner writes the final rules on poster board, and every scout and leader signs it.

**Example den Code of Conduct**

1. We listen when someone is talking. When the sign goes up, we get quiet. (Courteous)
2. We keep our hands and feet to ourselves. (Kind)
3. We use kind words, with no put-downs. (Friendly, Clean)
4. We include everyone. (Friendly)
5. We take care of our stuff and help clean up. (Thrifty, Helpful)
6. We follow our leaders' directions and stay safe. (Obedient)
7. We always do our best. (Cub Scout motto)

**ACTIVITY**

**Thumbs Vote.** Read each proposed rule; scouts vote thumbs up, sideways, or down. For any sideways or down votes, ask "How could we change it so you'd give a thumbs up?" This teaches that leaders listen, too.

Bring the poster to every meeting. If behavior slips, point to the poster instead of lecturing: "Which of *our* rules do we need right now?"

## 6

## REQUIREMENT 6

Demonstrate the Cub Scout sign, Cub Scout salute, and Cub Scout handshake. Show how each is used.

**Goal:** Scouts can correctly do all three and know when each one is used.

|                            | How to do it                                                                                                                                      | When we use it                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cub Scout sign</b>      | Raise your right arm straight up. Hold up your first two fingers (index and middle) in a V, with your thumb holding down your other two fingers.  | When saying the Scout Oath and Law, and as the <b>quiet signal</b> : when a leader raises the sign, everyone raises theirs and gets quiet. |
| <b>Cub Scout salute</b>    | Make the same hand shape, but put your first two fingers <b>together</b> . Touch your fingertips to your right eyebrow (or the brim of your cap). | To salute the flag when in uniform, and to show respect to leaders. (Out of uniform, place your right hand over your heart for the flag.)  |
| <b>Cub Scout handshake</b> | Shake right hands as usual, but put your first two fingers straight along the inside of the other person's wrist.                                 | Greeting other Cub Scouts and leaders, and when receiving an award.                                                                        |

## SAY IT LIKE THIS

"The two fingers in the Cub Scout sign stand for the **ears of a wolf**, alert and listening. That's why we use it to get quiet: when the sign goes up, our ears are open and our mouths are closed."

## ACTIVITY

**Leader Says (8 min).** Like Simon Says: "Leader says, give the Cub Scout salute!" Mix in "Leader says, show the sign," "Leader says, shake hands with the person to your left," and trick commands without "Leader says." Let the denner or scouts take turns being the leader.

**Quiet Sign Challenge.** Throughout the meeting, raise the sign at random moments. Time how fast the whole den gets quiet with their signs up. Can they beat their record next meeting?

**Handshake Line.** Scouts line up and shake hands with every leader using the Cub Scout handshake, looking them in the eye and saying "Hello, I'm \_\_\_\_."

## CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

- Watch each scout do all three correctly.
- Ask: "When do we use the sign? The salute? The handshake?"
- What's the difference between the sign and the salute? (Fingers apart vs. together, and arm up vs. at the eyebrow.)

## 7

## REQUIREMENT 7

At home, with your parent or legal guardian, do the activities in the booklet *How to Protect Your Children from Child Abuse: A Parent's Guide*.

**Goal:** Families have an age-appropriate conversation about personal safety at home, where the parent knows their child best.

**The leader's role**

- **Don't teach this in the den meeting.** It is designed to happen at home, between the scout and their parent or guardian.
- Send home the **Parent Letter**. The booklet is in the front of the Webelos Handbook and is also available on Scouting America's website.
- Mark the requirement complete when the parent or guardian confirms it's done (the tear-off slip on the letter works well).
- Follow up kindly with families who haven't finished; offer another copy of the booklet if needed.

**SAFETY FIRST**

If a scout ever tells you something that makes you think they may have been abused, stay calm, listen, and don't investigate. Follow your Youth Protection training: report it right away to local law enforcement or child protective services, and notify your Scout Executive. Every adult leader must have current Youth Protection training.

**Cubmaster's Minute: "The Bobcat"**

"Did you know a bobcat is small, only about twice the size of a house cat, but it's one of the most respected animals in the forest? It's not the biggest or the loudest. It's respected because it's *smart*, it's *careful*, and it's always *alert*. That's what the Bobcat adventure is about. You don't have to be the biggest or the loudest kid in your class to be a leader. You have to keep your promises, like the ones in the Scout Oath. You have to live the Scout Law even when nobody's watching. And you have to always do your best. Do that, and you'll be the kind of Scout everyone respects."

Write the date completed in each box. Requirement 7 is complete when the parent or guardian confirms it.

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

# Den Human Bingo

Find someone who matches each square and have them sign it. Each person can sign only one square!

|                                                            |                                                      |                                                            |                                                              |                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Has a pet</b><br>_____<br>signature                     | <b>Has been camping</b><br>_____<br>signature        | <b>Plays an instrument</b><br>_____<br>signature           | <b>Has a younger brother or sister</b><br>_____<br>signature | <b>Can do a cartwheel</b><br>_____<br>signature             |
| <b>Speaks more than one language</b><br>_____<br>signature | <b>Has been on an airplane</b><br>_____<br>signature | <b>Likes broccoli</b><br>_____<br>signature                | <b>Has a collection</b><br>_____<br>signature                | <b>Knows a magic trick</b><br>_____<br>signature            |
| <b>Was born in another state</b><br>_____<br>signature     | <b>Has helped cook dinner</b><br>_____<br>signature  | <b>FREE Webelos!</b>                                       | <b>Plays on a sports team</b><br>_____<br>signature          | <b>Can whistle</b><br>_____<br>signature                    |
| <b>Has planted something</b><br>_____<br>signature         | <b>Likes to draw</b><br>_____<br>signature           | <b>Has caught a fish</b><br>_____<br>signature             | <b>Has a birthday this season</b><br>_____<br>signature      | <b>Has built something with tools</b><br>_____<br>signature |
| <b>Has broken a bone</b><br>_____<br>signature             | <b>Loves pizza</b><br>_____<br>signature             | <b>Has been to a pro sports game</b><br>_____<br>signature | <b>Has read a book this week</b><br>_____<br>signature       | <b>Is new to the den this year</b><br>_____<br>signature    |

Print on cardstock and cut apart. Make one set per team for the relay, charades, and "Which Point Is It?"

|                    |                  |                 |
|--------------------|------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Trustworthy</b> | <b>Loyal</b>     | <b>Helpful</b>  |
| <b>Friendly</b>    | <b>Courteous</b> | <b>Kind</b>     |
| <b>Obedient</b>    | <b>Cheerful</b>  | <b>Thrifty</b>  |
| <b>Brave</b>       | <b>Clean</b>     | <b>Reverent</b> |